

Word-count declaration

Manuscript: *A Reproducible Benchmark of Relational Database Access-Layer Performance in Express.js: A Configuration-Specific Comparison on PostgreSQL and MySQL* (submission build `ist/ist_main.tex`).

Counted with `texcount` on the seven body sections plus the structured abstract. Following the IST author guidelines, each table and figure counts as 200 words, and **the reference list is included in the total**.

Component	Count
Body text (7 sections)	11,028
Structured abstract	298
Tables and figures in the main text (8×200)	1,600
Reference list (65 entries)	1,922
Total (IST rule)	14,848

This is under the journal’s 15,000-word limit (with the abstract counted; excluding the abstract it is 14,550). Twenty-seven tables and one figure are placed in the numbered online supplement (`supplement.pdf`, Supplement Tables S1–S27 and Supplement Figure S1), which is submitted with the manuscript and archived under the same Zenodo DOI as the code and data; supplement floats are not part of the main-text count.

In this revision (round 4) the manuscript was repositioned as a reproducible benchmark and a configuration-specific comparison; the body prose was cut by roughly 1,800 words to remove repeated conclusions and filler (the five recurring findings are now stated once, in the results section, and cross-referenced elsewhere); the secondary access patterns (point read, key-set range scan) were reduced to lean summaries with their full tables in the supplement; the controlled/varied/uncontrolled factor table was moved to the supplement (Table S27); and five peripheral citations (general NoSQL and OLTP benchmark context) were dropped, taking the reference list from 70 to 65 entries. Six single-host experiments added earlier in the round (utilization-controlled open-loop, multi-worker cluster, per-layer pool frontier on both engines, mixed read/write, replicated fan-out, and a longer-run sensitivity check) remain as Supplement Tables S21–S26 with a one-sentence pointer each in the body.

Highlights (5 bullets, each ≤ 85 characters) are in `highlights.tex`.